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Sediment control device

Abstract

A sediment control device is disclosed. The device includes an elongate fabric and a plurality of sleeves attached to the fabric. The plurality of sleeves extend generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the fabric and are configured to receive a stake for securing the sediment control device to soil. Each sleeve is spaced a distance from an adjacent sleeve. In use, the fabric is laid out along a soil path, a bottom portion of the fabric is trenched into soil, and the stake is inserted into each sleeve such that the sediment control device is secured to soil. The bottom portion can then be backfilled.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) The field of the disclosure relates generally to sediment control devices and, more particularly, to sediment control devices having a sleeve attached to a fabric for receiving a stake.

BACKGROUND

(2) Sediment control devices such as silt fences are utilized to minimize soil erosion caused by the elements. Common silt fences are made of an elongate fabric trenched into the soil and secured by a plurality of stakes attached to the fabric and driven into the soil. The elongate fabric can be soil-impermeable or water-impermeable so that soil or water from a construction site does not cross into nearby ecosystems. Soil-impermeable fabrics allow for water runoff to pass through the silt fence while the soil is retained, and water-impermeable fabrics, which are used less frequently, prevent both soil and water from passing through the silt fence.

(3) In use, the fabric is stretched between wooden or metal stakes along a desired soil control path, and a bottom edge of the fabric is trenched into the soil and backfilled. The fabric can be pre-attached to the stakes, or the stakes can be attached to the fabric after trenching and driving of the stakes into the soil. The fabric is attached to the stakes by suitable fasteners, e.g., staples, wire ties or zip-tie fasteners. Often, at least three attachment points are required to properly secure the fabric to the stakes. During typical installation, a first team of laborers are required to measure stake spacing and to drive the stakes into the soil to a specified depth, while a second team of laborers secure the fabric to each stake along the path. The fabric often has to be stretched and held stationary while a laborer secures the fabric to the stake.

(4) Silt fences can fail due to improper spacing of the stakes or failing to adequately secure the stakes to the fabric. Thus, some applications require additional reinforcement of the fabric to prevent heavier soil particles such as rock or clay from rupturing the fabric. Commonly, the fabric is reinforced by a backing of wire mesh or chain link fence. Where reinforcement is required, laborers must also secure the wire mesh or chain link to the fabric and to the stakes.

(5) Therefore, there is a need in the art for a sediment control device that reduces the labor requirement for installation while also streamlining the spacing of stakes and the attachment of stakes onto the fabric of the silt fence.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION

(6) In one aspect, a sediment control device is disclosed. The sediment control device includes an elongate fabric and a plurality of sleeves. The elongate fabric has a front, a back, a top edge, a bottom edge, a first lateral edge, and a second lateral edge. The plurality of sleeves are attached to

the back of the fabric, and each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extends generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongated fabric. Each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves is configured to receive a stake for securing the sediment control device to soil.

(7) In another aspect, a method of installing a sediment control device into soil is disclosed. The method includes positioning a bottom edge of an elongate fabric on the soil, the elongate fabric having a front, a back, a top edge, a first lateral edge, and a second lateral edge; inserting a stake into a sleeve of a plurality of sleeves attached to a back surface of the fabric, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extending generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongated fabric and being configured to receive the stake for securing the sediment control device to soil; and, further inserting the stake into the soil to secure the fabric to the soil

(8) In another aspect, a sediment control kit is disclosed. The sediment control kit includes an elongate fabric and a plurality of stakes. The elongate fabric has a front, a back, a top edge, a bottom edge, a first lateral edge, and a second lateral edge, and a plurality of sleeves attached to the back of the elongate fabric. Each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extending generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongate fabric and is configured to receive the stake for securing the sediment control device to soil.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a sediment control device in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a front view of the sediment control device of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a back view of the sediment control device of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is an enlarged, partial top view of the sediment control device of FIG. 1.

(5) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of the sediment control device of FIG. 1 trenched into soil.

(6) FIG. 6 is an enlarged, partial perspective view of the sediment control device of FIG. 5.

(7) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view of the sediment control device of FIG. 5;

(8) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional view of the sediment control device in accordance with one or more embodiments of the present disclosure; and,

(9) FIGS. 9A through 9C are cross-sectional view of installing the sediment control device of FIG. 1 into soil.

(10) The reference symbols used in the drawings, and their meanings, are listed in summary form in the list of reference symbols. In principle, identical parts are provided with the same reference symbols in the figures.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) In the following specification and the claims, reference will be made to a number of terms, which shall be defined to have the following meanings.

(12) As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. The terms “comprising,” “including,” and “having” are intended to be inclusive and mean that there may be additional elements other than the listed elements. The terms “optional” or “optionally” means that the subsequently described event or circumstance may or may not occur, and that the description includes instances where the event occurs and instances where it does not.

(13) Embodiments of the present disclosure are directed to a sediment control device including an elongate fabric and a plurality of sleeves attached to the fabric. The plurality of sleeves extend generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the fabric and are configured to receive a stake for securing the sediment control device to soil. Each sleeve is spaced a predefined distance from an adjacent sleeve. In use, the fabric is extended along a soil path, a bottom portion of the fabric is

trenched into soil, and the stake is inserted into each sleeve such that the sediment control device is secured to soil, and the fabric is stretched between inserted stakes. The bottom portion can then be backfilled.

(14) As shown in FIGS. **1** through **4**, a sediment control device, indicated generally at **100**, of the present disclosure includes an elongate fabric **120** and a plurality of sleeves **150** attached to the elongate fabric. Each of the plurality of sleeves **150** are configured to receive a stake **190** for securing the elongate fabric **120** to soil.

(15) The elongate fabric **120** of the exemplary embodiment shown in FIGS. **1-4** is an elongate, flexible, rectangular sheet having a front **122** (FIG. **2**) and a back **124** (FIG. **1**), a top edge **126** and a bottom edge **128**, and a first lateral edge **130** and a second lateral edge **132**. With reference to FIG. **3**, the top edge **126** and bottom edge **128** define a height H of the elongate fabric **120**. The first lateral edge **130** and second lateral edge **132** define a length L of the elongate fabric **120**. A longitudinal axis Y extends along the length L of the elongate fabric **120**. It is understood that the elongate fabric **120** of the illustrated sediment control device **100** can have any suitable height H and length L without departing from some aspects of this disclosure. For example, the elongate fabric **120** can have a height H in the range of 1 foot to 4 feet, and a length L in the range of 25 feet to 1500 feet. In some embodiments, the height H is in the range of 3 feet to 6 feet. In some embodiments, the length L is in the range of 5 feet to 8 feet, 7 feet to 10 feet or 9 feet to 12 feet. In some embodiments, the elongate fabric **120** is a continuous roll.

(16) In some embodiments, the elongate fabric **120** can be of a soil-impermeable or water-impermeable material so that soil or water from a construction site does not permeate through the elongate fabric **120** and cross into nearby grounds or ecosystems. In some suitable embodiments, the elongate fabric **120** includes a support structure **180** attached to the back **124** of the elongate fabric. In some other suitable embodiments, the elongate fabric **120** includes a support structure **180** attached to the front **122** of the elongate fabric. The support structure **180** can be attached to either the front **122** and/or back **124** of the elongate fabric to add rigidity to the elongate fabric **120** or to otherwise structurally support the sediment control device **100**. In some suitable embodiments, the support structure **180** is a wire mesh or a wire matrix.

(17) As shown in FIGS. **1** and **3**, each sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves is attached to the back **124** of the elongate fabric **120**. As seen therein, each sleeve extends generally perpendicular to the longitudinal axis Y and is configured to receive a stake **190** for securing the sediment control device **100** to soil **102** (as shown in FIG. **6**). In some suitable embodiments, each sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves is formed integrally with the elongated fabric **120**. In some other suitable embodiments, each sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves is welded (or otherwise suitably attached) to the back **124** of the elongate fabric **120**. With reference to FIG. **2**, each sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves is positioned a predefined distance D L from an adjacent sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150**. In some embodiments, the predefined distance D L is in the range of 10 feet to 20 feet. In some embodiments, the predefined distance D L is in the range of 1 foot to 4 feet, 3 feet to 6 feet, 5 feet to 8 feet, 7 feet to 10 feet or 9 feet to 12 feet. In some embodiments, the predefined distance DL is in the range of 12 feet to 16 feet.

(18) In some suitable embodiments, each sleeve **150** is formed integral with the elongated fabric **120** by folding the elongate fabric and bonding near the fold. The resulting sleeve **150** and elongate fabric **120** has an omega-shaped (“Ω”) cross-section. In some other suitable embodiments, as shown in FIG. **4**, each sleeve **150** is formed by looping a discrete sleeve fabric **152**, which is formed separately from the elongate fabric **120**, and attaching (e.g., by sewing, welding, or bonding) an outer surface **154** of the sleeve **150** to the back **124** of the elongate fabric. In some embodiments, as shown in FIG. **4**, lateral ends (**156**, **158**) of the sleeve fabric **152** are folded over each other and bonded together to form each sleeve **150**. In some embodiments, lateral ends (**156**, **158**) of the sleeve fabric **152** are connected together to form each sleeve **150**. It is contemplated the sleeves **150** can be made from the same material or different material than the elongate fabric **120**.

(19) Referring to FIG. 3, in some embodiments, each sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves extends a distance $D_{sub.1}$ from the top edge **126** of the elongate fabric **120**. The distance $D_{sub.1}$ from the top edge **126** of the elongate fabric **120** defines a top portion **160** of the elongate fabric **120**. Likewise, a bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** extends from the bottom edge **128** to the top portion **160** of the elongate fabric **120**. As explained in further detail below with reference to FIGS. 5-7 and 9A-9C, the bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** can be at least partially trenched into soil **102**. In some embodiments, the plurality of sleeves **150** extend from the top edge **126** to the bottom edge **128** of the elongate fabric **120**, and the bottom edge **128** is positioned against the soil **102**. In some embodiments, the distance $D_{sub.1}$ from the top edge **126** of the elongate fabric **120** is in the range of 2 feet to 3 feet. In some embodiments, the plurality of sleeves **150** extend 20% the length L of the elongate fabric **120**. Stated differently, in some embodiments, the distance $D_{sub.1}$ is 20% the length L of the elongate fabric **120**. In some embodiments, the distance $D_{sub.1}$ is in the range of 20% to 80% the length L of the elongate fabric **120**. In some embodiments, a first sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves has a distance $D_{sub.1}$ different from a distance $D_{sub.1}$ of a second sleeve **150** of the plurality of sleeves. Stated differently, in some embodiments, the plurality of sleeves **150** can have different distances $D_{sub.1}$.

(20) In some suitable embodiments, the support structure **180** extends from the top edge **126** of the elongate fabric **120** to the bottom portion **162**. In some other suitable embodiments, the support structure **180** extends partially into the bottom portion **162** such that only a portion of the support structure **180** is partially trenched into soil. It is contemplated that that no portion of the support structure **180** would be trenched into the soil during use. That is, the support structure **180** would be disposed above the soil during use. As mentioned above, in some suitable embodiments, the support structure **180** can be omitted from the sediment control device **100**.

(21) Referring to FIGS. 5-7, in use, the bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** is suitably trenched into soil **102**. Due to the flexibility of the elongate fabric **120**, the bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** can be forwardly bent relative to the front **122** of the elongate fabric **120**, providing further support to the sediment control device **100**. After trenching and backfilling the bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** into soil **102**, the stakes **190** can be inserted into the plurality of sleeves **150** and driven into the soil **102**. In the illustrated embodiments, the sediment control device **100** extends along a straight path. In some embodiments, the sediment control device **100** can extend along a curved path due to the flexibility of the elongate fabric **120**.

(22) As shown in FIG. 7, each stake **190** has a length L_s greater than the distance $D_{sub.1}$ of the plurality of sleeves **150** such that the stakes **190** extend beyond the top edge **126** of the elongate fabric **120**. Thus, driving the stakes **190** into soil **102** does not damage the elongate fabric **120** or the plurality of sleeves **150**. The stakes **190** are driven into the soil **102** by a distance D_s such that the sediment control device **100** is properly secured to the soil **102**. The stakes **192** can be secured to the elongate fabric **120** by a securement structure **191** at one or more points along the elongate fabric **120**. The securement structure **191** can be, for example, a zip tie, a staple, a wire, or a rebar tie which is passed through the elongate fabric **120**.

(23) As shown in FIG. 8, in some embodiments, the sediment control device **100** further includes a removable insert **192** which can be inserted into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** prior to inserting the stake **190**. The removable insert **192** is made from a rigid plastic and has a hollow cylindrical body. The removable insert **192** has an inner diameter $D_{sub.I}$ greater than a diameter D of the stakes **190** and the removable insert **192** has an outer diameter D_o lesser than a diameter $D_{sub.V}$ of the plurality of sleeves **150**. Because the sleeve fabric **152** of the plurality of sleeves **150** is flexible, the removable insert **192** causes the plurality of sleeves **150** to form a circular cross-section for aiding in insertion of the stakes **190**. Where the stakes **190** are made of wood, the removable insert **192** reduces splintering of the stakes **190** during insertion of the stakes **190** into the plurality of sleeves **150**. The removable insert **192** can be removed from each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** after the stake **190** is inserted into the removable insert **192**. In the

illustrated embodiment, a bottom end **194** of the removable insert **192** has flat cross-section (perpendicular to a length of the removable insert **192**). In some embodiments, the bottom end **194** is cut at an oblique angle to aid in insertion of the removable insert **192** into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150**. In some embodiments, the bottom end **194** has a V-shape.

(24) FIGS. **9A** through **9C** illustrate steps of a method of installing the sediment control device **100** into soil **102**. As shown in FIG. **9A**, the method includes trenching or digging a trench **104** into the soil **102** along a soil path and placing the bottom edge **128** of the elongate fabric **120** on the soil **102** such that at least the bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** is placed within the trench **104**. As shown in FIG. **9B**, the method further includes inserting a stakes **190** into each sleeve of a plurality of sleeves **150** and driving the stakes **190** into the soil **102** to secure the elongate fabric **120** to the soil **102**.

(25) As shown in FIG. **9C**, the method further includes backfilling the trench **104** with additional soil **106** to fill the trench **104** and bury the bottom portion **162** of the elongate fabric **120** into the soil **102**. In some embodiments, the method further includes securing the stake **190** to each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** with the securement structure **191**. In some embodiments, the method further includes inserting the removable insert **192** of FIG. **8** into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** prior to inserting the stake **190** into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** and, removing the removable insert **192** from each sleeve **190** of the plurality of sleeves **150**. In some embodiments, a shovel is used for trenching and backfilling the trench **104**, and a hammer or maul is used for driving the stakes **190** into the soil **102**. In some embodiments, a rotary hammer is used for driving the stakes **190** into the soil **102**.

(26) In use, the elongate fabric **120** of the sediment control device **100** is initially rolled up into a roll and one or two laborers can extend the first lateral edge **130** and the second lateral edge **132** of the elongate fabric **120** along the soil path. The elongate fabric **120** is then held upright at each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** and a stake **190** is driven through each sleeve and into soil **102**. Because each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves **150** are positioned the distance DL from adjacent sleeves (of FIG. **2**), laborers do not have to pre-measure stake insertion points along the soil path. Furthermore, because the stakes **190** are already attached to the elongate fabric **120** by the plurality of sleeves **150**, only one securement structure **191** (of FIG. **7**), is needed to secure the stakes **190** to the elongate fabric **120**, further reducing labor time during installation of the sediment control device **100**.

(27) A sediment control kit can include the elongate fabric **120** and plurality of sleeves **150** rolled into a roll, and the stakes **190** can be bundled up separately. Because the roll does not include the stakes **190**, the roll has a significantly lesser diameter than conventional sediment control devices with pre-attached stakes. In some embodiments, the sediment control kit further includes securement structures **191** in a separate container. In some embodiments, the sediment control kit further includes the removable insert **192**, or a plurality of removable inserts.

(28) Other variations to the disclosed embodiments can be understood and effected by those skilled in the art in practicing the claimed invention, from the study of the drawings, the disclosure, and the appended claims. In the claims the word “comprising” does not exclude other elements or steps and the indefinite article “a” or “an” does not exclude a plurality. The mere fact that certain measures are recited in mutually different dependent claims does not indicate that a combination of these measures cannot be used to advantage. Any reference signs in the claims should not be construed as limiting the scope of the claims.

(29) While the invention has been illustrated and described in detail in the drawings and foregoing description, such illustration and description are to be considered illustrative or exemplary and not restrictive. It will be understood that changes and modifications may be made by those of ordinary skill within the scope of the following claims. In particular, the present invention covers further embodiments with any combination of features from different embodiments described above and below. Additionally, statements made herein characterizing the invention refer to an embodiment of

the invention and not necessarily all embodiments.

(30) The terms used in the claims should be construed to have the broadest reasonable interpretation consistent with the foregoing description. For example, the use of the article “a” or “the” in introducing an element should not be interpreted as being exclusive of a plurality of elements. Likewise, the recitation of “or” should be interpreted as being inclusive, such that the recitation of “A or B” is not exclusive of “A and B,” unless it is clear from the context or the foregoing description that only one of A and B is intended. Further, the recitation of “at least one of A, B and C” should be interpreted as one or more of a group of elements consisting of A, B and C, and should not be interpreted as requiring at least one of each of the listed elements A, B and C, regardless of whether A, B and C are related as categories or otherwise. Moreover, the recitation of “A, B and/or C” or “at least one of A, B or C” should be interpreted as including any singular entity from the listed elements, e.g., A, any subset from the listed elements, e.g., A and B, or the entire list of elements A, B and C.

(31) This written description uses examples to disclose the invention, including the best mode, and also to enable any person skilled in the art to practice the invention, including making and using any devices or systems and performing any incorporated methods. The patentable scope of the invention is defined by the claims, and may include other examples that occur to those skilled in the art. Such other examples are intended to be within the scope of the claims if they have structural elements that do not differ from the literal language of the claims, or if they include equivalent structural elements with insubstantial differences from the literal languages of the claims.

Claims

1. A sediment control device comprising: an elongate fabric having a front, a back, a top edge, a bottom edge, a first lateral edge, and a second lateral edge; a plurality of sleeves attached to the back of the elongate fabric, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extending generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongate fabric and being configured to receive a stake for securing the sediment control device to soil, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves being spaced from the bottom edge of the elongate fabric, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves having an inner diameter and a first continuous height; and an insert sized and shaped for insertion into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves prior to the sleeve receiving the stake, the insert having an outer diameter that is less than the inner diameter of each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves, the insert having a second continuous height that is greater than the first continuous height of the sleeve, wherein the insert is selectively removed after the stake is received in one of the sleeves of the plurality of sleeves.
2. The sediment control device of claim 1, wherein each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves is formed integrally with the elongated fabric.
3. The sediment control device of claim 1, wherein each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves is welded to the elongate fabric.
4. The sediment control device of claim 1 further comprising a support structure attached to the back of the elongate fabric.
5. The sediment control device of claim 4, wherein the support structure is a wire mesh.
6. The sediment control device of claim 1, wherein each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extends a distance from the top edge of the elongate fabric, the distance from the top edge of the elongate fabric defining a top portion of the elongate fabric.
7. A method of installing a sediment control device into soil comprising: positioning a bottom edge of an elongate fabric on the soil, the elongate fabric having a front, a back, a top edge, the bottom edge, a first lateral edge, and a second lateral edge, the elongate fabric further having a plurality of elongate sleeves attached at spaced apart intervals along the back thereof, each sleeve of the

plurality of sleeves being spaced from the bottom edge of the elongate fabric, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extending generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongated fabric and including an inner diameter and a first continuous height; inserting an insert into one sleeve of the plurality of sleeves, the insert having an outer diameter that is less than the inner diameter of each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves, the insert having a second continuous height that is greater than the first continuous height of the sleeve; inserting a stake into the removable insert, the removable insert being sized and shaped to shield the sleeve from the stake; driving the stake into the soil to secure the elongate fabric to the soil; and removing the insert from the one sleeve of the plurality of sleeves after driving the stake.

8. The method of claim 7, further comprising trenching along a bottom portion of the elongate fabric, the bottom portion extending a distance from the bottom edge.

9. The method of claim 8, further comprising backfilling the bottom portion of the elongate fabric into the soil.

10. The method of claim 7 further comprising securing the stake to each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves.

11. The method of claim 7 wherein the removing of the insert from the one sleeve of the plurality of sleeves further includes removing the insert prior to or subsequent to the driving of the stake into the soil.

12. The method of claim 7 further comprising positioning the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge of the elongate fabric along opposite ends of a soil path prior to inserting stakes into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves.

13. The method of claim 7, wherein each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves is formed integrally with the elongate fabric.

14. The method of claim 7, wherein the elongate fabric includes a support structure attached to the back of the fabric.

15. A sediment control kit comprising: an elongate fabric having: a front, a back, a top edge, a bottom edge, a first lateral edge, and a second lateral edge; and a plurality of sleeves attached to the back of the elongate fabric, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves extending generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongate fabric and being configured to receive a stake for securing the sediment control device to soil, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves being spaced from the bottom edge of the elongate fabric, each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves having an inner diameter and a first continuous height; an insert sized and shaped for insertion into each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves prior to the sleeve receiving the stake, the insert having an outer diameter that is less than the inner diameter of each sleeve of the plurality of sleeves, the removable insert having a second continuous height that is greater than the first height of the sleeve; and a plurality of stakes, each of the plurality of stakes configured to be inserted into the insert and one of the sleeves of the plurality of sleeves, wherein the insert is selectively removed after the stake is received in one of the sleeves of the plurality of sleeves.

16. The sediment control kit of claim 15, wherein the elongate fabric is a roll.

17. The sediment control kit of claim 16, wherein the insert and the plurality of stakes are separate from the roll of elongate fabric.
